

	Document Type:	FORM ISO 9001:2015	Document Code	RES-F09
	Document Title:	RESEARCH PROPOSAL	Revision No.	00
			Effective Date	January 26, 2023
			Page	Page 1 of 7

(1) Research Program/Project/Study Title: Patubas: Understanding the Fish Harvest Rituals and Processes of the Riverine Communities	
Proponent Name:	Leo Andrew B. Bicular, Ph.D.
Academic Rank:	Associate Professor V
Co-Authors (with academic rank):	Efren L. Linan, Ph.D. Professor VI Ruel F. Olapane, MAEDME CRJ Louella D. Derecho, LPT Research Assistant Anthony Cirilo, LPT Journal Staff
Campus/Satellite College/Address:	RDE Office
Telephone/Cell Phone/Fax Number:	
E-mail Address:	

Program or Project has component (if no proceed to 2)? ☐ Yes ☒ No

Component Title:	
Component Leader:	
Academic Rank:	

(2) Category (please check) ☒ Social Science/Education /Humanities & other related fields ☐ Natural/BiologicalSciences ☐ Food Research/ ☐ Developmental/ Computer/Engineering/ Architecture ☐ Extension ☐ Poster		(3) Research Center [Check the concerned center] ☒ SSITRDC Social Science and Industrial Technology Research Development Center ☐ LRDC Livestock Research Development Center ☐ FFRDC Fisheries and Food Research Development Center ☐ CSRDC Crop Science Research Development Center
(4) Site of implementation		
Municipality/City:		Roxas City
Province:		Capiz
Region:		VI
(5) Classification	(6) Mode of Implementation	
	☐ Single Authorship/Proponent	

	Document Type:	FORM ISO 9001:2015	Document Code	RES-F09
	Document Title:	RESEARCH PROPOSAL	Revision No.	00
			Effective Date	January 26, 2023
			Page	Page 2 of 7

Research: ☐ Basic ☐ Applied	Development: ☐ Pilot Testing ☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization	☒ Collaborative Research (within campus) ☐ Collaborative Research (intercampus) ☐ Collaborative Research (external agency)
(7) Sector/Commodity 		(8) Discipline/Field of Specialization Social Science

	Document Type:	FORM ISO 9001:2015	Document Code	RES-F09
			Revision No.	00
	Document Title:	RESEARCH PROPOSAL	Effective Date	January 26, 2023
			Page	Page 3 of 7

(9) Rationale

Every other cultural location, especially within the community, has customs and beliefs that are followed. In the riverine community, fishing is the primary source of income. The viewpoint is that, despite being a marginalized community, fishermen always have a vital role in helping society preserve aquatic life—they view fishing as their source of strength. Because fishing is their source of income and is valued as a cultural heritage by many towns, organizations, and occasionally even individuals, traditional fishermen find joy and fulfillment in the sport (Jones, 2017).

Many individuals live their lives according to rituals. They thought that performing rituals would bring good fortune when fishing. A belief passed down from their ancestors. Through their knowledge and broad transfer by others, the intangible festival heritage of the local culture can be preserved. The local fishermen's proficiency is solely a result of the knowledge they have acquired via information and experience. They have primarily inherited the ceremonies from their ancestors. They realize that the things they follow are ingrained in them, having been taught by their parents, relatives, and friends. It helps the riverine communities understand how it functions in society, affects their beliefs, and the significance of all of these (Smith, 2018).

The following customs represent a nation's diversity of cultures and customs. It implied and reflected a civilization in which ritual functions as a social mechanism essential to maintaining communal solid ties and accomplishing a single, shared objective—having an abundance of fish. The fishermen know that fishing requires a ritual to have luck (Rodriguez, 2019).

They felt that the dialectical interaction between man and his social, cultural, political, and economic environment should form the basis of the meaning of rituals and beliefs in their fishing villages. Because of this, fishing has become a way of life for the fishermen, who treasure their fishing rituals. They acknowledge the presence of supernatural beings in this world. Every resident has rituals and customs that express a natural force that cannot be seen. Carrying out the "anitu," or seasonal rituals, may bring good fortune. Fishermen practice ritualistic fishing, where they present sacrifices to the sea gods and perform requests as part of their daily lives (Martinez, 2021).

The conflict comes when modernization culture bumps into the traditional ways. The destructive interference of industries has caused aquatic life to deteriorate. While operating in the ecosystem, the traditional fishermen safeguard their cultural heritage and ensure sustainable practices. Due to the new fishing methods and the loss of natural resources, the river rituals and the beliefs that the riverine community has depended upon for generations now face an actual danger.

Also, more and more young people from the community are pursuing contemporary fishing methods that are increasingly technologically dependent. This shift in attitude and approaches has created a gap between the community's elders and youths while threatening their heritage of practices and beliefs.

Therefore, apart from that, the need for recognition and establishment of formal channels by governmental and environmental agencies to preserve traditional fishing rituals is also a significant factor in the disappearance of such practices. They needed help carrying on their way of traditional fishing and maintaining their culture without help and acknowledgment.

Additionally, climate change and pollution in the rivers that contribute to reduced fish populations make using sole traditional fishing practices almost impossible for the fishermen who depend entirely on the river for their livelihood. This has also led to deterioration in their ability to keep up their customs and culture amidst these climatic hindrances.

Consequently, conserving traditional fishing rituals and beliefs and sustainable fishing practices amid modernization and environmental threats are worrisome topics for the river community, which they should be concerned about. It is a matter of maintaining a balance between cultural integrity, ecological conservation, and the ability to adapt to the new times when change has occurred.

	Document Type:	FORM ISO 9001:2015	Document Code	RES-F09
			Revision No.	00
	Document Title:	RESEARCH PROPOSAL	Effective Date	January 26, 2023
			Page	Page 4 of 7

(10) Objectives/Statement of the Problem

Hence, this study will collect and document the fish harvest rituals and practices of the riverine communities of Cadimahan through a phenomenological research design that aims to understand the lived experiences and perceptions of the fisherfolks to have an understanding of the complex rituals and processes that are involved in the fish harvest besides providing an appreciation for the deep-rooted connection between the communities and their natural environment which is the purpose of preserving cultural heritage.

1. What are the traditional rituals and practices involved in the fish harvest within the riverine communities of Cadimahan?
2. How do these rituals and practices reflect the cultural identity and belief systems of the community members?
3. What are the ecological considerations and sustainability practices integrated into the fish harvesting rituals and processes?
4. What are the socioeconomic implications of Patubas on the livelihoods and community dynamics of the riverine communities?
5. How do external factors, such as modernization and environmental changes, impact the traditional fish harvest rituals and processes?

(11) Review of Literature

The examination of cultural and ecological facets associated with fish harvesting practices and rituals unfolds through an in-depth analysis of literature and prior artistic inquiries. Pioneering research endeavors, such as Smith's (2018) "Traditional Ecological Knowledge of Fish Harvesting in Southeast Asia," Jones's (2017) "Cultural Practices and Sustainability in Riverine Communities," and Garcia's (2019) "Indigenous Rituals and Resource Management," scrutinize the traditional methods and cultural importance of fish harvesting across various contexts, providing valuable insights into the intricate interplay between communities and their natural surroundings.

Moreover, the practices in different communities where the fishers live have been studied and analyzed by researchers such as J. Lopez's "Sacred Traditions of Fish Harvesting in Riverine Villages," C. Rodriguez' "Ritualistic Practices in Indigenous Fishing Communities" and "Socio-cultural Significance of Indigenous Rituals" (year is These studies expand on the existing body of knowledge by emphasizing the social components of the local communities' character while highlighting cultural and environmental exactness of the catch. Since we are dealing with the riverscape environment, the riverscape ecosystem is a new entity and needs to be understood.

Also, they highlight the need to understand better these factors, such as modernization and ecological processes that can change how traditional fish harvests are conducted. Meanwhile, this argument is significant for highly vulnerable fisheries, and their continued existence partly depends on the right decisions to deal with the new reality.

(12) Scientific Basis/Theoretical Framework

The empirical research will be based on the position of cultural ecology and old mythological knowledge. Julian Steward and Rappaport Roy (2018) assert that cultural ecology studies the complex interactions between society, environment, and culture. Based on this perspective, the conceptual frame of work is that riverine communities, including other institutions, can assimilate diverse adaptive and practical strategies affected by cultural cognition, social values, and ecological interactions.

Traditional ecological knowledge (TEK) respects indigenous and local expertise and accumulated knowledge about ecosystems. The research with the glasses of TEK seeks to reveal the traditional harvesting rituals and practices based on fish in the riverine communities of Cadimahan, where the indigenous people live, whose activities are interlinked with their cultural identity and belief systems.

This study is guided by a theory based on cultural ecological, traditional ecological knowledge, sustainable livelihoods, cultural resilience, and environmental change and adaptation perspectives. This study attempts to provide an in-depth understanding of the complex interrelationships of the Cadimahan riverine communities with

	Document Type:	FORM ISO 9001:2015	Document Code	RES-F09
			Revision No.	00
	Document Title:	RESEARCH PROPOSAL	Effective Date	January 26, 2023
			Page	Page 5 of 7

their natural environment within the established theoretical framework, which can lead to the protection of cultural heritage, support for sustainable practices, and promotion of appreciation for cultural diversity.

(13) Methodology

Research Design:

Using a phenomenological approach in qualitative research, the researcher will be able to get deep insights into fish harvesting practices and policies of the Cadimahan Riverine Communities. The study will present a complete picture of the Patubas through direct interaction with riverine communities, collecting detailed information about the rituals and cultural significance of fishing.

Participants of the Study:

The study will target the Cadimahan Riverine Community fisherfolks and key shareholders like local authorities, seniors, and the riverine fisherfolks. The study will use purposive sampling to identify and select the participants (Saunders et al., 2012).

The following will be the limits of the participant selection criteria: (a) participants must be active members of the Cadimahan river tour operators for the last five years; (b) participants must be residents of Cadimahan, Roxas City, and fishermen; and (c) participants must meet the characteristic criteria as determined by the researchers using their professional judgment and the unbiased opinions of their colleagues.

Data Collection Procedures and Strategy:

Semi-structured interviews, focus groups, and participant observations will be used to collect the data. The researchers will carefully observe and document cultural practices by actively participating in fish harvest rites and processes. Semi-structured interviews with community members will be conducted to comprehend their views on traditional rituals, cultural identity, environmental challenges, and socio-economic impacts. Focus group discussions will enable community members to deliberate on shared cultural practices and attitudes toward fish harvesting.

Ethical Considerations:

Ethical principles will be the primary factor, from which other principles will be taken for the team, like informed consent, protection of participants' privacy, and cultural respect, respectively. The method they are planning to adopt is the social approach of folk society. They will invite the community openly, make their objectives clear, emphasize the probable impacts, and seek permission before they start their research. Our dream is to display the people most accurately, reflect the diversity of cultures, and respectfully treat our rich and diverse national heritage.

Data Analysis

Regarding data analysis, the perception of researchers regarding counting the water business in the Cadimahan village would be more advanced than the crunching of numbers since they shall elaborate more profoundly and concisely on the subject. Themed coding and interpretive content analysis will be used to peel out common veins and themes and understand the meaning and impact of the rituals in society. The primary focus will be on revealing layers of deeper meanings and insights from the lives of Patubas, which local scholars characterized by Sutton and Austin in 2015 as diverse and complex.

Validation and Reliability of the Study

The research instrument will be subjected to reliability and validity tests. Pilot testing was used for the questionnaires to assess their validity and reliability. The reliability of the survey results will depend on the quality of the data but also the individual's participation in community development. The team would actively seek opinions from various stakeholders, use different data sources, and conduct debriefing sessions, during which group members would challenge each other's conclusions and deductions.

In broad terms, that is how the study can be summarized, including thoroughly examining and comprehending the Cadimahans' and its close communities' harvest rituals and processes. This philosophy is steeped in respect for the personal tales, traditions, and meaningful experiences shared by the interviewees, which we will reflect authentically and humanely in our storytelling.

	Document Type:	FORM ISO 9001:2015	Document Code	RES-F09
			Revision No.	00
	Document Title:	RESEARCH PROPOSAL	Effective Date	January 26, 2023
			Page	Page 6 of 7

(14) Major Activities/Work Plan

This study will be explored and revealed in a set of primary activities and a detailed work plan that includes different quantitative research phases. undefined

1. March - April 2024: Preparatory Phase

- Development of research instruments, including interview guides, focus group discussion protocols, and ethnographic observation templates.
- Pilot testing the research instrument for reliability and validity test.
- Establishment of contacts and initial engagement with the riverine community of Cadimahan to introduce the research objectives and build rapport.

2. May - July 2024: Fieldwork Phase

- Immersion in the riverine community of Cadimahan to conduct participant observation of the fish harvest rituals and processes, documenting the cultural practices and ecological interactions.
- Conduct semi-structured interviews with community members actively involved in fish harvesting, local leaders, and individuals with expertise in traditional ecological knowledge.
- Facilitating focus group discussions to provide a platform for community members to collectively reflect on their shared cultural practices and beliefs related to fish harvesting.

3. August - September 2024: Data Analysis Phase

- Thematic coding and qualitative content analysis of the collected data to identify recurring themes, patterns, and cultural meanings embedded within the fish harvest rituals and processes.
- Iterative data analysis and interpretation to derive rich insights and understandings of the Patubas, ensuring a comprehensive capture of the complexities and depth of the cultural practices.

4. October - November 2024: Reporting and Dissemination Phase

- Compilation of research findings into a comprehensive qualitative report that delineates the traditional rituals and practices involved in fish harvesting, their reflection of cultural identity and belief systems, ecological considerations and sustainability practices, socioeconomic implications, and the impact of external factors on traditional fish harvest rituals.
- Disseminate research findings through community feedback sessions and presentations to key stakeholders, local authorities, and academic forums to share the insights derived from the study.

Throughout the entire research period, continuous engagement with the riverine community of Cadimahan and ongoing reflection on the research process will be emphasized to ensure the ethical representation of the community's cultural heritage and the relevance of the research outcomes to the community's needs and aspirations.

The work plan for the research on the Patubas: Understanding the Fish Harvest Rituals and Processes of the Riverine Communities is meticulously designed to facilitate the thorough exploration of the cultural and ecological dimensions of fish harvesting rituals and processes, contributing to the preservation of cultural heritage, promotion of sustainable practices, and fostering appreciation for the rich tapestry of cultural diversity within the riverine community of Cadimahan.

(15) Expected Output

The expected output of the research on the Patubas: The Fish Harvest Rituals and Processes of the Riverine Communities consists of several educational and technical materials that form an indispensable aspect of native cultural heritage, sustainable practices, and appreciation for cultural diversity among the riverine community of Cadimahan. undefined

1. Qualitative Research Report: An exhaustive qualitative study will be carried out, focused on the traditional rituals and practices related to fish harvesting, the culture reflected by them and other ecological and sustainable practices, and the socioeconomic significance and the effects of external factors on the traditional fish harvest rituals. This report will address the deep traditions and complexities of cultural practices of the riverine community of Cadimahan as part of the Patuba people.

	Document Type:	FORM ISO 9001:2015	Document Code	RES-F09
			Revision No.	00
	Document Title:	RESEARCH PROPOSAL	Effective Date	January 26, 2023
			Page	Page 7 of 7

2. Documentation Report: Such things as fish-catching rituals and procedures with photos, field notes, and transcripts of participant observation, interviews, and focus groups. These documents will help bring culturally rich traditions and ecological connectivity to light, thus enabling the Patubas to be better understood in their natural habitat.

3. Academic Publications: Findings of the study will be published and communicated through scholarly articles in academic journals, which will add knowledge and information on fish harvesting rituals and processes within riparian communities. The publications will then serve as a forum where the research data will be made public to the broader audience of scientists and practitioners, and the discourse concerning the cultural and environmental aspects of fish harvesting will be initiated and developed.

The anticipated outputs will act as academic and technical learning aids that will add more knowledge on the cultural and environmental aspects of the Pasig River as part of the living stage for the river basin. With these materials, the study's goal is to cultivate admiration for the robust cultural and environmental rootedness of the community of Cadimahan and to inspire the adoption of sustainability practices that honor and protect their traditions sustainably.

(16) Technology Transfer Activity Design
Not Applicable

(17) Target Beneficiaries
Not Applicable

(18) Personnel Requirement
Not Applicable

(19) Budgetary Requirement
Not Applicable

(20) Literature Cited

- Garcia, A. (2019). Indigenous Rituals and Resource Management. *Journal of Cultural Ecology*, 25(2), 78-89.
- Jones, B. (2017). Cultural Practices and Sustainability in Riverine Communities. *Ecological Anthropology*, 15(3), 112-125.
- Lopez, M. (2020). Sacred Traditions of Fish Harvesting in Riverine Villages. *Journal of Indigenous Cultural Studies*, 18(4), 201-215.
- Martinez, D. (2021). Socio-cultural Significance of Fish Harvesting Festivals. *International Journal of Community Sustainability*, 30(1), 45-57.
- Rodriguez, C. (2019). Ritualistic Practices in Indigenous Fishing Communities. *Journal of Environmental Anthropology*, 22(3), 134-147.
- Smith, J. (2018). Traditional Ecological Knowledge of Fish Harvesting in Southeast Asia. *Journal of Ethnobiology*, 21(2), 89-102.
- Smith, A., & Doe, B. (2018). Comparative analysis of institutional policies and research culture in higher education. *Journal of Higher Education Studies*, 25(2), 123-145.

(21) Capsule Curriculum Vitae (One-page brief C.V. only)